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FINTECH



**PayPal taps wallets from
China and India to make
cross-border payments
easier for 2 billion people**

PayPal announced Wednesday it has partnered with global wallet companies to create a platform called [PayPal World](#) that is designed to make cross-border commerce easier. The platform will allow users to pay others using their local wallets and payment systems.

The company said the launch partners include India's NPCI International Payments Limited, which operates mobile payments framework UPI (Unified Payment Interface); China's Tenpay Global (Tencent's payment arm), which operates the Weixin (WeChat) payment ecosystem in the country; PayPal; and Venmo.

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The company has also signed a memorandum of understanding with Latin America's Mercado Pago, a fintech company that enables card and mobile payments, while the final details of the deals are being ironed out.

With these partnerships, PayPal wants to cover more than 2 billion users across the world.

“PayPal World is a first-of-its-kind payments ecosystem that will bring together many of the world's largest payment systems and digital wallets

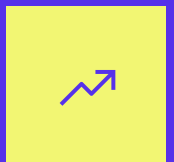
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on a single platform,” Alex Chriss, president and CEO of PayPal, said in a statement.

“The challenge of moving money across borders is incredibly complex, and yet this platform will make it so simple for nearly two billion consumers and businesses. We believe the changes we are announcing today have the potential to be a real game changer over time.”

The fintech company said that through PayPal World, PayPal and Venmo users will be able to send money to anyone in the world, even if they aren’t a PayPal user. For instance, when they are traveling in China, they can use PayPal on the Weixin payment network to pay to local businesses. On the flip side, if a customer from India is buying from a site in the U.S., they can use PayPal to check out and pay through their UPI wallet.

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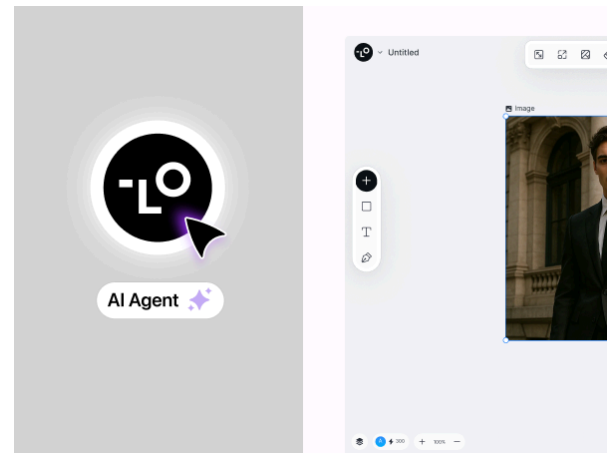
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Total user base and transaction volume of these wallet systems are massive. For instance, Mercado Pago’s total payment volume was [\\$58.3 billion in the](#)

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[first quarter of 2025](#). In India, UPI transactions hit more than \$238 billion just for the month of June, [according to NPCI data](#).

China's Tenpay is also working on creating a better remittance framework along with enabling cross-border peer-to-peer payments.

"We are glad that Tenpay Global, Tencent's cross-border payment platform, will support users of PayPal and Venmo in making payments by scanning Weixin Pay¹ QR codes, further expanding access for global digital wallets to transact in the mainland of China. In addition to payments, Tenpay Global will deepen its collaboration with PayPal World in remittances," Wenhui Yang, CEO of Tenpay Global, said.

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PayPal World is set to kick off the platform this fall with its launch partners. The company said that in 2026, Venmo users will be able to pay for shopping both online and offline for merchants that support PayPal's payments.

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PHOTO BY THOMAS TRUTSCHEL/PHOTOTHEK / GETTY IMAGES (IMAGE HAS BEEN MODIFIED)

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PayPal's new 'super app,' to include messaging, is ready to launch

Sarah Perez — 7:25 AM PDT · July 29, 2021

PayPal's [plan to morph itself into a "super app"](#) has been given a go for launch.

According to PayPal CEO Dan Schulman, speaking to investors during this week's second-quarter earnings call, the initial version of PayPal's new consumer digital wallet app is now "code complete" and the company is preparing to slowly ramp up. Over the next several months, PayPal expects to be

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fully ramped up in the U.S., with new payment services, financial services, commerce and shopping tools arriving every quarter.

The company has spoken for some time about its “super app” ambitions — a shift in product direction that would make PayPal a U.S.-based version of something like China’s WeChat or Alipay or India’s Paytm. Like those apps, PayPal aims to offer a host of consumer services under one roof, beyond just mobile payments.

In previous quarters, PayPal said these new features may include things like enhanced direct deposit, check cashing, budgeting tools, bill pay, crypto support, subscription management, and buy now, pay later functionality. It also said it would integrate commerce, thanks to the mobile shopping tools acquired by way of its [\\$4 billion Honey acquisition](#) in 2019.

So far, PayPal has continued to run [Honey](#) as a standalone application, website and browser extension, but the super app could incorporate more of its deal-finding functions, price-tracking features and other benefits.

[PayPal details its digital wallet plans for 2021, including crypto, Honey integration and more](#)

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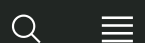
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On Wednesday's earnings call, Schulman revealed the super app would have a few other features as well, including high-yield savings, early access to direct deposit funds and messaging functionality outside of peer-to-peer payments — meaning you could chat with family and friends directly through the app's user interface.

PayPal hadn't announced its plans to include a messaging component until now, but the feature makes sense in terms of how people often combine chat and peer-to-peer payments today. For example, someone may want to make a personal request for the funds instead of just sending an automated request through an app. Or, after receiving payment, a user may want to respond with a "thank you," or other acknowledgment. Currently, these conversations take place outside of the payment app itself on platforms like iMessage. Now, that could change.

"We think that's going to drive a lot of engagement on the platform," said Schulman. "You don't have to leave the platform to message back and forth."

With the increased user engagement, the company expects to see a bump in average revenue per active account.

[Venmo to gain crypto, budgeting, savings and Honey integrations this year](#)

Schulman also hinted at "additional crypto capabilities," which were not detailed. However, PayPal earlier this month [increased the crypto](#)

[purchase limit](#) from \$20,000 to \$100,000 for eligible PayPal customers in the U.S., with no annual purchase limit. The company also this year made it possible for [consumers to check out at millions of online businesses](#) using their cryptocurrencies, by first converting the crypto to cash then settling with the merchant in U.S. dollars.

Though the app's code is now complete, Schulman said the plan is to continue to iterate on the product experience, noting that the initial version will not be "the be-all and end-all." Instead, the app will see steady releases and new functionality on a quarterly basis.

However, he did say that early on, the new features would include the high-yield savings, improved bill pay with a better user experience, and more billers and aggregators, as well as early access to direct deposit, budgeting tools and the new two-way messaging feature.

To integrate all the new features into the super app, PayPal will undergo a major overhaul of its user interface.

"Obviously, the [user experience] is being redesigned," Schulman noted. "We've got rewards and shopping. We've got a whole giving hub around crowdsourcing, giving to charities. And then, obviously, buy now, pay later will be fully integrated into it. ... The last time I counted, it was like 25 new capabilities that we're going to put into the super app."

The digital wallet app will also be personalized to the end user, so no two apps are the same. This will be done using both artificial intelligence and machine learning capabilities to "enhance each customer's experiences and opportunities," said Schulman.

PayPal [delivered](#) an earnings beat in the second quarter with \$6.24 billion in revenue, versus the \$6.27 billion Wall Street expected, and earnings per share of \$1.15, versus the \$1.12 expected. Total payment volume from merchant customers also jumped 40% to \$311 billion, while analysts had projected \$295.2 billion. But the company's [stock slipped](#) due to a lowered [outlook for Q3](#), impacted by eBay's transition to its own managed payments service.

In addition, PayPal gained 11.4 million net new active accounts in the quarter, to reach 403 million total active accounts.

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Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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PayPal's ambition and uphill battle in China

Rita Liao — 3:22 AM PDT · April 28, 2021

Over the last few months, PayPal has been quietly gearing up for its expansion in China.

At the recent Boao Forum for Asia, China's answer to Davos, the American payments giant [said](#) its strategy for China is not to challenge the duopoly of Alipay and WeChat Pay. Instead, it wants to focus on cross-border business and provide gateways both for Chinese merchants to sell overseas and for Chinese consumers to pay for foreign goods.

It's certainly a lucrative area. The market size of cross-border e-commerce in China surged from about 3 trillion yuan (\$460 million) to nearly 6 trillion

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yuan between 2016 and 2021, according to market research firm [iResearch](#).

But this space has also become crowded in recent years, and PayPal may be late to the fray, said a China-based manager for an American tech giant, who asked for anonymity because he's not authorized to speak to the media.

On Amazon, one of the largest marketplaces for Chinese exporters to sell online, there are already established options for merchants to collect funds. Setting up a bank account in a foreign country can be difficult for a small-time Chinese exporter, not to mention the high fees for remittance, so such merchants often seek third-party payments transfer solutions such as U.S.-based Payoneer and Chinese equivalents [PingPong](#) and [LianLian](#), which charge a relatively small fee to deposit merchants' sales into their bank accounts at home.

[China postpones Ant's colossal IPO after closed-door talk with Jack Ma](#)

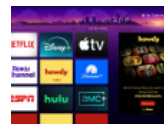
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China has stringent policies for foreign exchange and electronic payments, but PayPal has already cleared the regulatory hurdles. In January, the American fintech titan became the first foreign firm to hold a license for online payment processor in China after it [bought out shares in a local payments firm](#).

Obtaining the government greenlight is just the first step. The appeal of PayPal hinges largely on what it can offer to Chinese e-commerce exporters, who are now flooding the likes of Amazon and eBay.

“At the end of the day, customers only care which service is the cheapest and easiest to use,” said the China-based manager from the American firm.

“The Chinese cross-border payment solutions have achieved impressive results in terms of products, scale and fees,” the person said. “I don’t think PayPal stands a chance.”

Exporters who build their own online stores instead of selling on mainstream marketplaces may still find PayPal necessary as a tool to accept payments from customers, given the app’s wide reach.

As for cross-border payments, PayPal is competing with Tencent’s WeChat Pay and Ant Group’s Alipay, which have long been ubiquitous in China. Both e-wallets have been aggressively growing their global partnerships to let China’s outbound travelers pay at overseas retailers like they would at home. Those shopping for overseas products domestically often use Chinese-owned e-commerce apps, which tend to have Alipay or WeChat Pay as their payment processor. Credit cards never became prevalent in China.

Cross-border payments have also become one of Ant’s main growth goals, according to the [prospectus](#) of its [now-halted initial public offering](#). While overseas businesses accounted for just

about 5% of the firm’s revenue in the second half of 2020, most of that segment came from cross-border payments. At the time, Ant also had plans to spend HK\$52.8 billion, or 40%, of the net proceeds from its IPO on expanding its cross-border payment and merchant services as well as other overseas functionalities.

“It depends on whether PayPal is able to offer even lower fees than Ant,” said a person who previously worked on cross-border wallets for a Chinese company. “But PayPal itself is not famous for low fees.”

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